

c. 1940

to Father Provincial, and, I believe, that was Monday of Holy Week last year. I positively failed to recognize his voice. Next day, our dear friend, Father Coughlin, called me from Royal Oak, whither Father M. J. had come and said Holy Mass. Again, his voice was so strange that even when the two of them assured me it was he who was talking, I could not recognize anything like his own voice. Father Provincial sent me out to see what might be done for him, etc.,

We had dinner together with Father Coughlin and household; after which the three of us had a confidential conference for half an hour or so. -- Fr. C. God bless him, was as practical and as earnest as if he were broadcasting to millions. On his appeal to do so, Mr. M. J. came home to the Monastery and apologized to Father Provincial for any scandal caused; upon which followed a conference that was not too tame or too promising amicable, anyhow. (?)

With his letter of "exit, etc.," he took an air-plane to Chicago, on his way, as we all presumed, back to Saint Paul, or, as I thought, possibly to the Coast before returning to his diocese. However, he seemed so little his real self that my heart was heavy. All I could do was just hope and pray on, as I am sure, poor saintly Mother must have felt and done five and fifty years before, when he broke down at the Seminary and came home, etc., You can figure, therefore, on my surprise, when a few days later I received a wire from the very Rev. Rector of St. Mary's Seminary, Baltimore, Maryland, that Father M. J. had come thither and was not well. He had said Holy Mass once or twice with some difficulty, -- I learned by 'phone that night, and had gone to New York. About a year before that, I had started to read the fourth book of the Mystical City of God. -- "THE CORONATION," -- and, as yet, I was only about half through. You have an idea, I am sure, of how little time I get to read outside the Monastery office. Well, instead of speeding up my efforts to finish the book, I decided to start over again and to read it with due reverence from the beginning. Without a word about it to anyone, I felt that our Blessed Mother would know what I was doing and why. . . . I could hardly help being anxious. I try not to be. Rather, on the contrary, am trying to foster confidence in the wisdom and goodness of God and the powerful intercession of our Blessed Mother Mary. "Deo Gratias."

Well, a few days later, a telegram from the Monastery on West 31st St., N. Y.-City, to the effect that Fr. wanted to get into St. Elizabeth Hospital. What to do? So far, he had failed Father Provincial had gone to Calvary, Wis., in the meantime, and on reception of the telegram by special delivery, wired the Fr. Guardian in 31st St., to do all in his power to help Father get into St. Elizabeth's or some other like it. Poor Fr. M. J. however, could not be located Heart-sick, as I imagine he must have been, at disappointment after disappointment in the East, he had turned his steps again westward. This a second communication from Baltimore indicated hardly a week after the former.